

English

Unit 1 - My World

WALT: 6Rm.01 Understand, with support, most of the main points of short and extended texts.

6Rm.02 Read independently a range of short, simple fiction and non-fiction texts with confidence and enjoyment.

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I can read a text.



**With support, I can
answer questions on
a text.**



**Independently, I can
answer questions on
a text.**

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Retrieval Practice

Explain why you chose the text you did.

Text 1	Text 2
Here's something you'll find funny. Scientists have absolutely no idea how, or when for that matter, seals managed to get themselves to a lake in the middle of Russia – which is zillions of miles from the nearest ocean. Weird, hey?	The presence of seals in the deep interior of Russia has puzzled evolutionary biologists. They are uncertain as to how, or at which time, the animals came to be so far from the open ocean.

The information in both texts is the same but the language used is different.

Tick (✓) the text you prefer to read.

Text 1

☐

Text 2

☐

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Starter – Does your name have a meaning? What does it mean?



Colette
people of victory

Origin: French
Pronunciation: c(o)-lette, col(et)-te

Mama Natural



John
John is name of Hebrew origins
meaning God is gracious.

Origin: Hebrew
Pronunciation: j(ohn)

Mama Natural

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Read this text about “A Girl Called Owl.”

Part 1

A Girl Called Owl

by Amy Wilson



When you have a kid, don't call it something stupid. Don't call it Apple or Pear or Mung Bean. Don't call it Owl.

This advice is a bit late for me. Because she did. She did call me that years ago she looked down at a tiny little baby – me – and decided it would be a good way to go.

I guess she didn't know then that I would have white-blond hair, like my face, like **feathers**, no matter what I do with it. That my eyes were a baby blue to the palest brown, almost yellow; that my nose was a **beaky** side.

Part 2



She should have seen that last one coming though; I **inherited** it from my mum. I like owls. I think they're beautiful, but you know, my head doesn't **rotate** 360 degrees. I can't fly. I don't hunt at night.

All these are questions the other kids have asked me, over the years. Mum always tells me when I tell her.

'See!' she cries, looking up from whatever she's doing, a glint in her eye. 'Already you stand out in the crowd. Already you are different. Isn't it a wonderful thing?'

She's beautiful, my mum. Not in a **subjective** way, like she's my mum, she must be beautiful. She's actually beautiful. She has these big dark eyes, a lot of dark hair, and when she smiles, when she laughs, it's difficult not to smile. I do try my very best not to join in.

Her name is Isolde. She wears lots of bright colours, and **tinkling bangles** on her wrists. She smells of warm things: **vanilla**, cinnamon, oranges and blackberries, and something deeper that's just her, I guess.

My friends love her. Which is annoying.

Glossary
beaky: shaped like a bird's beak

Owl and her friend, Mallory, have just had a maths lesson. Owl was told off by the teacher for sketching owls instead of paying attention.

It was an owl. The doodle in my maths book. I draw them, over and over. Little ones, big ones, owls with crazy **whirly** eyes, owls **swooping** down from the sky. They're in all the **borders** of my lined school books. They're on Post-it notes around my bedroom. I have **sketches** of them, paintings, even little clay figures.

I'm not saying they're good. Actually, if you walked into my bedroom, you'd probably run back out again, screaming. They're a bit **intense**.

Mum loves them. **Loves** them. She thinks it's me expressing myself.

Drawing myself, over and over again.

Mallory just rolls her eyes when she sees a new one now. She bought me a card with a **puffin** on it for my birthday a couple of weeks ago.

'Maybe a change?' she wrote inside, 'Now that you're thirteen?'

But I'm not **called** Puffin.

And there had to be a reason.

A reason Mum called me Owl.



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Now lets read it together.

When you have a kid, don't call it something stupid.

Don't call it Apple or Pear or Mung Bean.

Don't call it Owl.

This advice is a bit late for me. Because she did. She did call me Owl. Thirteen years ago she looked down at a tiny little baby – me – and decided that Owl would be a good way to go.

I guess she didn't know then that I would have white-blond hair that flicks around my face, like **feathers**, no matter what I do with it. That my eyes would turn from baby blue to the palest brown, almost yellow; that my nose would be on the **beaky** side.

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She should have seen that last one coming though; I **inherited** it from her.

I like owls. I think they're beautiful, but you know, my head doesn't **rotate** 360 degrees. I can't fly. I don't hunt at night.

All these are questions the other kids have asked me, over the years. Mum laughs when I tell her.

'See!' she cries, looking up from whatever she's doing, a glint in her dark eyes.

'Already you stand out in the crowd. Already you are different. Isn't it a wonderful thing?'

She's beautiful, my mum. Not in a **subjective** way, like she's my mum therefore she must be beautiful. She's actually beautiful. She has these big dark eyes, **masses** of dark hair, and when she smiles, when she laughs, it's difficult not to join in.

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I do try my very best not to join in.

Her name is Isolde. She wears lots of bright colours, and **tinkling bangles** on her wrists. She smells of warm things: **vanilla**, cinnamon, oranges and blackcurrants, and something deeper that's just her, I guess.

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Which is annoying.

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I'm not saying they're good. Actually, if you walked into my bedroom, you'd probably run back out again, screaming. They're a bit **intense**.



Mum loves them. *Loves* them. She thinks it's me expressing myself.

Drawing myself, over and over again.

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But I'm not *called* Puffin.

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A reason Mum called me Owl.

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Now answer questions 2 – 8 in your notebooks.

Page 21 -23

- | | |
|---|--------------|
| a Owl likes her unusual name. | true / false |
| b Owl thinks that she looks like an owl in some ways. | true / false |
| c She doesn't look like her mum at all. | true / false |
| d Other children have asked questions about her name. | true / false |
| e Owl's mum thinks the other children's questions are a good thing. | true / false |
| f Owl is pleased that her friends like her mum. | true / false |
-
- | | |
|--|--------------|
| g Owl draws lots of pictures of owls in her school books and in her bedroom. | true / false |
| h Her mum doesn't like her drawings. | true / false |
| i Her friend Mallory thinks she should continue drawing lots of owls. | true / false |
| j Owl thinks that there must be an explanation for her unusual name. | true / false |

3 Work in pairs. Can you correct the false sentences?

4 Answer the questions. Find sentences in the story to support your answers to the inference questions.

a How do you think Owl feels about the questions other children ask her?

b Do you think Owl is always happy with her mum?

c Why does Owl think her drawings are 'a bit intense'?

d Why do you think she is always drawing pictures of owls?

5 **Word study** Work out the meaning of the words in blue in the story by looking at other words in the sentence. Then match to the definitions.

a to fly down very fast

b something that covers a bird's body

c to be born with the same features as one of your parents

d a pattern of circles

e lots of

f very strong feeling

g move round and round

6 Talk about the questions in groups.

a Which features and characteristics have you inherited from members of your family?

I have dark eyes like my dad.

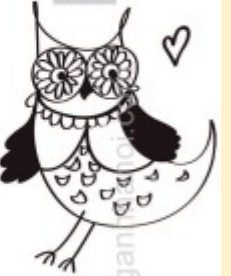
b Why do you think Owl's mum chose her name for her? Do you know anyone with an unusual name? How do they feel about it?

7 **Values** Accepting our differences. Owl's mum is pleased that her name makes her 'stand out from the crowd', but Owl is not so sure. What advice would you give her?

8 In what ways can we feel different to other people? How can this be a good thing?

Reading tip
Inference
The answers to inference questions are not in the story text. To answer, you must use clues in the text, and your own experience, then draw a conclusion.

Low Res



Your name is special because it is unique, you should be proud of it.

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g Owl draws lots of pictures of owls in her school books and in her bedroom.

true / false

h Her mum doesn't like her drawings.

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j Owl thinks that there must be an explanation for her unusual name.

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Now answer questions 2 – 8 in your notebooks.

3 Work in pairs. Can you correct the false sentences?

- 3 a** Owl doesn't like her name.
- c** She has the same shaped nose as her mum.
- f** She finds it annoying that her friends like her mum.
- h** Her mum loves her drawings.
- i** Mallory thinks Owl should change and draw another type of bird.

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4 Answer the questions. Find sentences in the story to support your answers to the inference questions.

- a** How do you think Owl feels about the questions other children ask her?
- b** Do you think Owl is always happy with her mum?
- c** Why does Owl think her drawings are 'a bit intense'?
- d** Why do you think she is always drawing pictures of owls?

annoying.') The last two points imply that Owl resents her mum in some ways, even though she loves her.

b No, not always. The story infers that Owl gets annoyed because her mum doesn't seem to understand how her unusual name can make her feel embarrassed (e.g. about other children's questions) ('All these are questions the other kids have asked me, over the years. Mum laughs when I tell her.') At other times, Owl doesn't want to join in when her mum is having fun, even if she wants to laugh too ('... when she laughs, it's difficult not to join in. I do try my very best not to join in.') Owl also says that she gets annoyed because her friends love her mum ('My friends love her. Which is

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c She tells us that she draws owls all the time ('I draw them, over and over'), in many different forms ('Little ones, big ones, owls with crazy whirly eyes, owls swooping down from the sky'). Her school books and bedroom are full of owl pictures ('They're in all the borders of my lined school books. They're on Post-it notes around my bedroom. I have sketches of them, paintings, even little clay figures.') For another person, the effect could be quite disturbing ('Actually, if you walked into my bedroom, you'd probably run back out again, screaming. They're a bit intense.')

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d The story infers that her name is something that Owl thinks about a lot. She seems interested to know why she is called 'Owl' ('And there had to be a reason. A reason Mum called me Owl.');

during her life, there has been a lot of interest about her name from other children.

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- e** lots of
- f** very strong feeling
- g** move round and round

- 5**
- a** swooping
 - b** feathers
 - c** inherited
 - d** whirly
 - e** masses
 - f** intense
 - g** rotate

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Plenary – Did you enjoy the text?

Why / Why Not?